

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1997-08-18

To all National Spiritual Assemblies dear b ahá'í f

1 the disturbing news that two more believers in iran have been killed because
2 of their faith. while you may share this information with your community,
3 no action should be taken at this time to publicize it in the media.
4 mr. masha'llah enayati (m ashá'lláh 'i náyatí), a 63-year-old bahá'í resi-

**dent of øihrán, who was well known for having constantly taught the
faith in a bold and zealous manner, died on 4 j uly 1997 after being**

5 severely beaten while in custody. during a visit to his native village of
6 Ardistán to attend the meeting held to commemorate the anniversary of the
Ascension of bahá'u'lláh, mr. enayati was arrested in circumstances 253.3

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255 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

256 600 which are not clear. he was taken to prison in i l fahán, where he was

257 severely beaten on all parts of the body. it appears that he was held in

258 prison for about a week before being taken to a hospital. his daughter,

259 who lives in Australia, was in iran at the time and visited her father in

260 the hospital, where he was still under armed guard, though it was only

261 a minor matter for which he had been arrested. She witnessed the effects

262 of the beating, including visible bruising all over his body and especially

263 on his hands, which were black from his injuries. She reports that he was in good
health before his arrest. mr. e nayati passed away in the hospital.

264 The friends in iran have added that mr. enayati's death certificate is

265 worded in a most unusual way, suggesting that the doctor may himself have been
under threat and thereby pressured to falsify the certificate. under "cause of death" is
entered, " will be known later," in the hand-

266 writing of the doctor.

mr. Shahram reza'i (Shahrám riṣá'í), a young bahá'í man who was serv-

267 ing as a conscript in the army near the city of rasht, was shot in the head by
268 his weapons training officer on 6 july 1997 and died the following day. in
269 court the officer claimed that the shooting was an accident. he was released
270 after a few days, once the court established that the man killed was a bahá'í.

271 The court excused the officer of paying the blood-money normally required in such
instances, ordering him to pay just the cost of the three bullets used

272 to kill mr. r eza'i. The f riends in i ran have no doubt that this was a case of
273 deliberate murder and predicted before the "trial" that the officer would be
274 released, since this has been so in other similar cases. we understand that
275 mr. reza'i is the seventh bahá'í undertaking compulsory army duties to
276 have been killed by colleagues or officers.

277 below is the provisional translation of the text of a letter written on
278 behalf of the h ouse of j ustice for transmission to i ran:

events which engulfed the two lovers of the Abhá beauty, Shahrám

riṣá'í and mashá'lláh 'i náyatí. These two trod the path of truthful-

279 ness and fearlessness and never concealed their relationship with the
world-embracing Teachings of bahá'u'lláh; this resulted in fueling the
280 fire of prejudice amongst heedless individuals, and finally in leading

**the two to the exalted station of martyrdom and the attainment of the
presence of the d esired o ne.254.3**

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255 1996–2000 • T h e f o u r Y e a r P l a n

256 601kindly inform the families of these dear ones of the heartfelt sympa-
257 thy of the house of justice and assure them of its prayers in the holy

Shrines for the two martyrs in the path of god and also for those

258 oppressed ones who survive them.

The willful killing of mr. enayati and mr. reza'i, occurring without

any justification whatsoever, illustrates how the persecution of the

259 believers in i ran is continuing to take place in various ways . . .

260 with loving b ahá'í greetings,

for Department of tHe secretariat

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Leadership of the Faith

Following the Passing of the Guardian

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]